Onupurba Das

Ph.D. Candidate, Environmental Economics

Department of Resource Economics
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Website

Education

May 2025 (expected) **Ph.D. Environmental Economics**, *Department of Resource Economics*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2015 – 2017 **M.Sc. Environmental Economics**, *Madras School of Economics*, Chennai. Central University of Tamil Nadu, India

2010 – 2013 **B.A. Economics**, *Madras Christian College*, Chennai. Madras University, India

Fellowships

2017 – 2022 **Research Enhancement and Leadership (REAL) Fellowship**, *Graduate School*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2020 **Vijay Bhagavan Teaching Assistant of Distinction Award**, *Department of Resource Economics*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2021 **Summer Fellowship**, *Department of Resource Economics*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2018 **Summer Travel Grant**, *for UC Berkeley Environmental and Energy Economics Workshop*, Department of Resource Economics, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

Professional Experience

2023 – Present **Quantitative Methodology Consultant**, *Institute of Social Science Research*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2023 – Present **Econometrics Fellow**, *Quantitative & STATA consultant*, Amherst College.

2013 – 14 **Operations Analyst**, *Goldman Sachs*, Bangalore.

2012 **Summer Internship**, *Goldman Sachs*, Bangalore.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Associate, University of Massachusetts Amherst

Workshop, *Data Management in Stata with Multiple Datasets*, Institute of Social Science Research.
Fall 2024, Spring 2024

Workshop, *Say it with a Graph! (in Stata)*, Institute of Social Science Research.
Spring 2024

Workshop, *Introduction to Stata*, Institute of Social Science Research.
Fall 2023

Instructor, *Environmental Economics (Res-Ec 262) Online Version*, University Without Walls - Continuing & Professional Education.
Summer 2022, Summer 2020, Summer 2019

Instructor, *Don't Panic: A Guide to College, Economics and the World Beyond (Res-Ec 191)*, Social and Behavioral Sciences First Year Seminar.
Fall 2023, Fall 2022

Instructor, *Understanding Resource Economics (Res-Ec 191)*, Social and Behavioral Sciences First Year Seminar.
Fall 2020, Fall 2019

Discussion Session Instructor, *Intermediate Statistics for Business and Economics (Res-Ec 213)*.
Fall 2021, Spring 2021, Spring 2020

Guest Lecture, *Environmental Economics (Res-Econ 262)*.
Spring 2022

Guest Lecture, *Senior Departmental Honors Seminar*, **Amherst College**.
Fall 2023

Undergraduate Supervision

Supervisor for Undergraduate TA , *First Year Seminar*.
Fall 2022, Fall 2020, Fall 2019

Teaching Assistant, University of Massachusetts Amherst

Res-Ec 702, *Econometric Methods*, Graduate level.
Spring 2023

Res-Ec 701, *Probability Theory and Statistical Inference*, Graduate level .
Fall 2022, Fall 2019

Res-Ec 471, *Cost Benefit Analysis*.
Spring 2023

Res-Ec 262, *Environmental Economics*.
Spring 2022

Res-Ec 213, *Intermediate Statistics for Business and Economics*.
Fall 2021, Fall 2020

Res-Ec 313, *Quantitative Methods in Applied Economics*.
Spring 2018, Fall 2017

Res-Ec 112, *Computing: Foundations to Frontiers*.
Fall 2020

Working Papers

Caste Based Quotas in Politics and Deforestation in Rural India.

Gender Based Quotas in Politics and Deforestation in Rural India, *(with Jamie Mullins)*.

Impacts of Increasing Temperatures on Mental Health in India, *(with Jamie Mullins & Kavita Sardana)*.

Other Research Experience

2019 **Research Assistant**, *Supervised by Jamie Mullins*, Department of Resource Economics, University of Massachusetts Amherst.
Summer 2019

2018 **Research Assistant**, *Supervised by Jamie Mullins & Daniel Lass*, Department of Resource Economics, University of Massachusetts Amherst.
Summer 2018

Conferences

2021 **Presenter and Discussant**, *Eastern Economic Association Annual Conference - Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Sessions*, Session: Environment and Development, February 2021.
Title: *Gender Based Reservations in Politics and Deforestation in Rural India*

2020 **Presenter**, *Northeast Agricultural and Resource Economics Association (NAREA) 2020 Annual Meeting*, Session: Environmental Economics, November 2020.
Title: *Gender Based Reservations in Politics and Deforestation in Rural India*

2018 – 2022 **Presenter**, *Department of Resource Economics Annual Graduate Conference. Fall 2022, Fall 2021, Fall 2020, Fall 2019, Fall 2018*

2019 – 20 **Presenter**, *Department of Resource Economics, Environmental and Natural Resources Economics Group.*

2018 – 2020 **Participant**, *World Interdisciplinary Project (WSIP) Workshop.*

Service Experience

2021 – 2023 **Co-Chair**, *Graduate Students of Color Association*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2019 – 2021 **Executive Board Member**, *Graduate Students of Color Association*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2019 – 21 **Executive Committee Member**, *Resource Economics Graduate Council*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2021 – 23 **Senator**, *Graduate Student Senate*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2019 – 20 **Steward**, *Graduate Employee Organization*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2021 **Panelist**, *Women in Economics*, Department of Economics and Department of Resource Economics.

2018 – 2020 **Mentor**, *REAL Fellowship*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2021 – **Member**, *India Civil Watch - International.*

2019 – **Organizer**, *Progressive South Asians Students Forum*, Western Massachusetts.

2021 **Co-organizer**, *Dalit History Month Special on Breakfast with DuBois*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

Professional Development

2020 **Mentee**, *AEA CSWEP Successfully Navigating Your Economics PhD.*

2018 **Workshop**, *Berkeley/Sloan Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics*, University of California Berkeley.

2016 **Workshop**, *Gender Dimensions of Social and Economic Policies*, Global Initiative of Academic Networks (GIAN), Indian Institute of Technology Madras.

2015 **Workshop**, *Modern Finance and Macroeconomics: A Multidisciplinary Approach*, International Center for Theoretical Sciences, Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, Bangalore.

2020 **Workshop**, *Participant Observation and Ethnographic Fieldnotes*, Institute for Social Science Research, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2020 **Workshop**, *Mapping Data with QGIS*, Institute for Social Science Research, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2018 **Workshop**, *Data Management in R and Practical Web and Text Scraping*, Institute for Social Science Research, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2018 **Workshop**, *Environmental Social Science Research: Commonalities and Conundums*, Institute for Social Science Research, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2018 **Workshop**, *Beginner and Intermediate STATA Workshop*, Institute for Social Science Research, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2017 – 2019 **Member**, *Environmental Working Group*, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

2016 – 2017 **Editorial Board**, *Athena Magazine*, Madras School of Economics.

2019 **Course**, *Teaching in the Social and Behavioral Sciences*, Department of Sociology, University of Massachusetts Amherst.

Data Management Tools

STATA, *Primary data management tool for research projects.*

ArcGIS, *Model building and Geo-Spatial Data.*

Statistical Methods, *Ordinary Least Squares, Logit/Probit and other basic methods*, Causal Inference: Difference-in-differences, Regression Discontinuity, Instrument Variables etc.

References

Dr. Jamie Mullins (Advisor)
Associate Professor
Department of Resource Economics
University of Massachusetts Amherst
✉ jmullins@umass.edu

Dr. Jessica Pearlman
Director of Research Methods Programs,
Institute of Social Science Research
University of Massachusetts Amherst
✉ jpearlman@issr.umass.edu

Dr. Bernie Morzuch
Professor
Department of Resource Economics
University of Massachusetts Amherst
✉ berniemorzuch@umass.edu